r/forkliftmechanics • 9mo ago
u/JackieZZZZZ

Safety concern about Electric forklift battery position

I am purchasing some electric forklifts to replace old one.

I noticed Toyota Core forklift's battery position is high, we have one of this forklift and it running good. But when I search other vendors products, I noticed majority of battery are at lower position. I know lower battery position means better weight balance. However, my experience is dock pit level could hit forklift and damage the pipe (propane equipment). Should I worry about battery get damage by pit leveler?

For propane equipment we can know, but for battery this is hidden damage.



TOYOTA's lead acid battery position.

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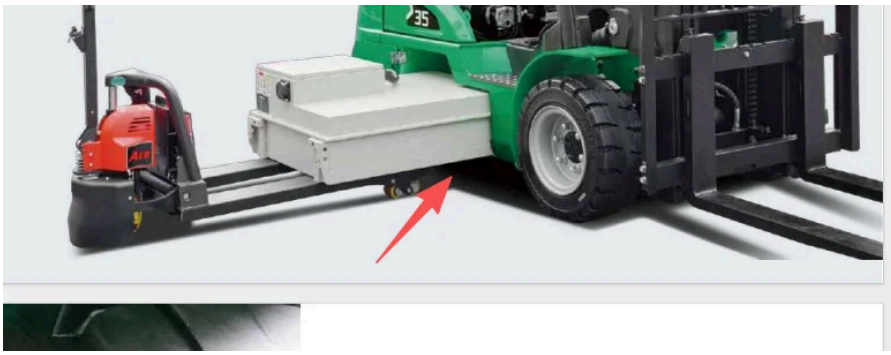
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MODERATORS



A brand I am considering, but 80v battery location is very low.



TOYOTA 80v battery position

Update

I went to other warehouse today to check their HELI, the position is also similar as TOYOTA CORE.

For those battery at lower position (bottom), I can only assume they are sharing IC propane forklift chassis to build the electric forklift.

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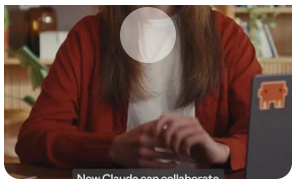
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BiscuitWizardz • 9mo ago

The lifts with the battery in the bottom of the chassis are not popular at all in my part of the US, so I can't speak to them, however, the Toyota forklift in your first picture is one of the best electric forklifts on the market. Absolute workhorse.

13 Reply ···

JackieZZZZZ OP • 9mo ago

That Core is very good, we have them in NJ warehouse. Now I am purchasing for TX warehouse, 2 shifts, so we plan to purchase Li ion, charging is super fast. (plus I do not need install the exhaust required by fire marshal). TOYOTA CORE is about 16k higher than lead acid, and Raymond similar model is aksing for 59k if I remember correct.

I just realize our Linde E25 also has battery at lower part. No problem about these battery but Linde quality is horrible nowaday.

0 Reply ···

AdministrationIll842 • 9mo ago

Lithium ion don't like cold, heat, or vibration. I'm not a fan. 30 year tech.

1 Reply ···

JackieZZZZZ OP • 9mo ago

Yeah, Houston is slightly different than my other experience. I was not able to get a permit for propane storage tank, the big one. Rencently due to weather propane small tanks could not delivery on time so we are in trouble. I have to add a few electric forklifts to this site. For Lead Acid battery they are good,

not care.

2 Reply ...



AdministrationIll842 • 9mo ago

Make sure they understand that it's part of their job and a condition of steady employment. Really, you need to check it once a week. If you're in top of it, it's not very time consuming. Look into automatic watering systems and low water blinky lamps. Makes it even easier. Outweighs the cost and downtime I've seen with Lit Ion.

1 Reply ...



Breakfast_Forklift • 9mo ago • Edited 4mo ago

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3 Reply ...



JackieZZZZZ OP • 9mo ago

I do not really think pit leveler panel can strike into battery. Just It happend before, some lower pipe got damaged when driver push product with a slightly fast speed, you know not many trailers/containers have been adjusted by trucker to perfectly fit dock height.

I do not really need 80v, one of vendor provide 48v CATL 606Ah. Our building is brand new, 480v just installed with new panel.

I am still thinking about using TOYOTA CORE, we are using 5000 lb and some of them have carton clamp. But Hangcha seems a good choice in our budget range. Our combination will be 6 reach&cherry, 4 e-fork.clamp, 8 propane sitdown/clamp.

1 Reply ...



Breakfast_Forklift • 9mo ago • Edited 4mo ago

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2 Reply ...



JackieZZZZZ OP • 9mo ago

You are right, now Hangcha is asking for 16 wks lead time, Toyota is 9 wks to delivery. I

2 Reply ...

Breakfast_Forklift • 9mo ago • Edited 4mo ago

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1 Reply ...

Metalliclaker • 9mo ago

Just sent you a DM. Happy to help!

1 Reply ...

u/huntresslabs • Ad

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NowhereBoy1 • 9mo ago

Your first photo is the most common position for battery. I'm in UK though

1 Reply ...

JackieZZZZZ OP • 9mo ago

May I know which brand you are using, or any recommand?

1 Reply ...

NowhereBoy1 • 9mo ago

Linde, Cat, Toyota

1 Reply ...

JackieZZZZZ OP • 9mo ago

I had really bad experience with Linde. Unit DOA, 30% new units, E25 model down in 1 month. CAT I do not see a lot these days, our old IC (propane) CAT are still good. Toyota for sure is good.

1 Reply ...

toyota.

Its like comparing a golf cart to a f150.

They both have wheels but only one does the job.

Battery placement is the least of your problems, also youre comparing a lithium-Ion to a lead acid. Completely different. Ask hangcha if your insurance will cover if the battery catches fire or if the charger is certified. Also also them if you can buy a new battery, fix that battery, or get a charger and what the lead time is.

Also ask them to look at their floors, chinese forklift tires can stain floore badly depending on the finish used. Not sure why honestly but there's some chemical that no other brands us that the Chinese ones do. Ask me how I know.

1 Reply ···

JackieZZZZZ OP • 9mo ago

Battery & charger & insurance, that's a good point. The lead time is horrible, 14 wks for a new forklift, I guess parts take longer.

1 Reply ···

ShadowOfaTower • 8mo ago

Lithium ion doesnt work in forklifts. Its outragously expensive and continually changing because it doesnt work. Any benefit they offer is lost in cost and expensive maintenence. If you dont want to deal with watering and lead acid, i would suggest a tppl battery. A tppl battery in a toyota or raymond 4750 (same machine) is a relatively trouble free set up. As for your actual question im not sure. Guess i just hate lithium ion lol

1 Reply ···

JackieZZZZZ OP • 8mo ago

Thanks for your information. Let me check TTPL if vendors have quote

1 Reply ···

Competitive-Golf-130 • 8mo ago

I'm planning to replace my forklift battery with a $LiFePO_4$ battery.

1 Reply ···

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JackieZZZZZ OP • 9mo ago

Yes, normal flat service movement is fine. I am worry about loading trailers. It does not happen a lot, once a year on propane equipment. But for battery I am afraid it could burn during night charging period.

1 **Reply** ···

[deleted] • 9mo ago

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JackieZZZZZ OP • 9mo ago

Thanks for your information. I purchased 6 e-pallet jack with that LiFePo battery. Vendor said I may need to charge 30 mins during break time, but actually we only charge it every 2 days, durable. Charging is like 1 hr, very fast. Our team like these devices. In our new site we have 10x 480v 20A

1 **Reply** ···